

➤ Writing

INTEGRATED ESSAY “SCHOOL ORGANIZATION”

First, read the passage on page 64 and take notes.



Model Test 1, Writing Section, CD 2, Track 2

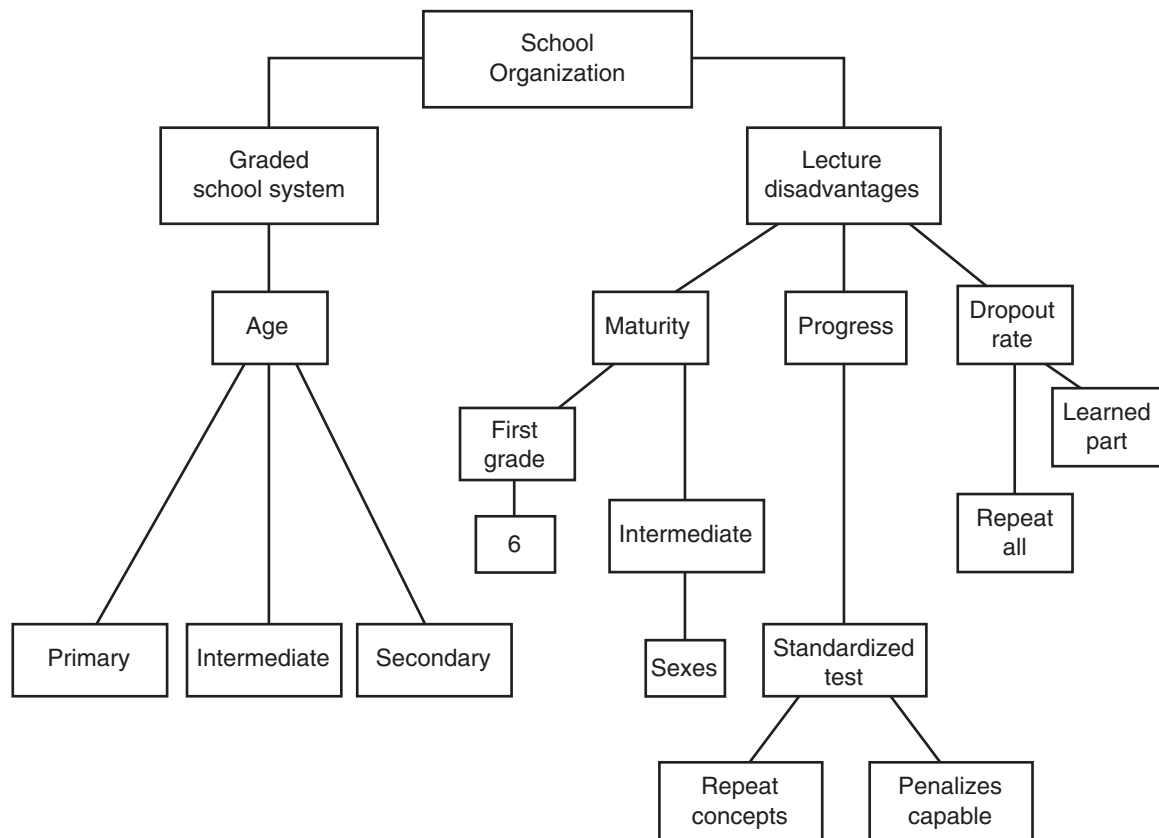
Narrator: Now listen to a lecture on the same topic as the passage that you have just read.

Professor:

So what are the problems associated with the graded school system? Well, for one thing, graded schools don't take into account the . . . the differences in academic readiness on the part of individual learners. And by that I mean that some six-year-olds are simply not socially, mentally, or even physically mature enough to begin school, but others are ready in all of those important ways by their fifth or even fourth birthdays. And uh . . . by the time that girls and boys are in their early teens, we can see that there's a significant difference in maturity, in . . . in physical and social maturity but . . . they're still grouped together in intermediate grades in a graded school system.

Okay, besides the obvious differences in individual readiness and maturity, the . . . the whole issue of promotion needs to be reviewed. Grade-level requirements don't really deal with the actual learning that has occurred, uh, in a positive way. Many research studies confirm that repeating an entire year because some of the material is not learned contributes to . . . to boredom, poor self-concept, and . . . and eventually to higher drop-out rates. And since graded schools are using group expectations as measured by performance on standardized tests, this is another way to evaluate the group rather than the individual. So, what happens is that individual differences in how long it takes to learn a concept or . . . or the partial achievement of a grade-level curriculum . . . that is never addressed by the graded school system. Students who need more time to learn have to repeat material that they already know. Students who can learn at a faster rate have to wait for the new material to be presented. So, as you can see, it's not ideal.

Map



Example Essay

The graded school system, which groups students by age, is usually divided into primary, intermediate, and secondary grades. However, according to the lecture, there are several disadvantages to this type of system. In the first place, maturity is not considered. All students begin the first grade at six years old; however, many children are not mature enough to go to school at that age. In contrast, some younger children are ready for school before their sixth birthdays but are denied the opportunity to begin until they reach the required age of six. In addition, the disparity in the maturity of girls and boys is marked in the intermediate grades. Nevertheless, they are still scheduled for classes according to age, not maturity. Even more concerning is the problem of grade-level standards, which rely on testing to evaluate progress by age instead of by actual mastery on the part of individuals. The grade-level system is inefficient because it requires some learners to repeat concepts that they have already learned in order to master those that they still need to know. It also penalizes students who are capable of learning more material than the grade-level curriculum allows. Furthermore, research shows a correlation between low self-esteem and drop-out rates with the requirement that students repeat a calendar year because they have not learned part of the material for their grade.

Checklist for Integrated Essay

- ✓ The essay answers the topic question.
- ✓ Inaccuracies in the content are minor.
- ✓ The essay is direct and well-organized.
- ✓ The sentences are logically connected.
- ✓ Details and examples support the main idea.
- ✓ The writer expresses complete thoughts.
- ✓ The meaning is easy to comprehend.
- ✓ A wide range of vocabulary is used.
- ✓ The writer paraphrases in his/her own words.
- ✓ The writer credits the author with wording.
- ✓ Errors in grammar and idioms are minor.
- ✓ The essay is within a range of 150–225 words.

Sample Answer – TOEFL IBT Placement test

As a beginner in entertainment, I see merit in both Amy and Ben's perspectives. Amy advocates for online streaming's convenience and diverse content, while Ben emphasizes traditional TV's community-building and accessibility, especially in rural areas. Considering both, I lean towards supporting traditional television. Despite streaming's benefits, TV ensures inclusivity for those without reliable internet. Government investment in TV infrastructure can bridge the digital divide, ensuring entertainment access for all. Thus, while online streaming offers modernity, prioritizing traditional TV aligns with inclusivity and equal access, crucial values in today's entertainment landscape.